CAPYBARA

Hydrochoerus hydrochaeris

1. What can it see, hear, or feel?
Its eyes sit high, its ears pick up soft splashes, and its nose knows every friend in the group.

2. Where does it live — and why?
It lives near rivers and flooded grasslands, where water is an escape and mud keeps skin cool.

3. How does it send messages?
It barks a sharp warning, hums and purrs to stay in contact, and uses scent to mark plants.

4. What does it do when something changes?
When startled, the whole group rushes into the water, and it can hold its breath for minutes.

5. How does it learn?
Young ones follow adults to feeding spots and learn which sounds mean danger is coming.

6. How does it have babies?
A mother has two to eight babies, and several females take turns nursing the whole group's young.

7. What are its limits?
Without water close by, it cannot hide from big predators or cool off in the heat.

8. What does this teach us?
One animal watching the water's edge can keep the whole group safe.

WHY IS THIS ANIMAL HERE?

Capybaras live near wetlands, rivers, and ponds across South America.

Wetlands are being drained for farming and building.

Capybaras need both water and open grass to stay safe and cool.

When its habitat shrinks:

- less water means fewer places to hide from predators
- family groups get pushed onto smaller, drier patches of land
- wild wetlands — home to many species — keep shrinking

This place is not their natural home, but it can help keep the species alive.

THINK ABOUT THIS

If you could stay calm around almost any other animal, who would you want as a neighbor?

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.

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